

Experience:

Freelancer / Contractor

UX, UI, motion, design

Cape Town
April 2023 – Present

My focus is on how AI is fundamentally changing the way digital products are conceived, designed, and delivered.

Beyond simply using AI as a productivity tool, I'm exploring how structured knowledge, design systems, and intelligent workflows can be orchestrated into a scalable operating model for product teams.

This includes areas such as functional specification generation, design intelligence, rapid prototyping, token-driven UI architecture, automated testing, and creating stronger continuity between design intent and production-ready software.

I'm particularly interested in how organisational knowledge can be captured, structured, and continuously enriched so that AI becomes a reliable design collaborator rather than just another assistant. The objective isn't simply faster delivery, but more consistent decision-making, higher quality outputs, and systems that improve as they accumulate experience.

For me, this represents the natural evolution of Design and UX leadership: moving beyond designing interfaces to designing the intelligence, processes, and knowledge frameworks that enable teams to build better products at scale.

Catch & Release - Agency

Lead UX designer

Cape Town
February 2022 – April 2023

Catch & Release serves as the in-house digital agency for the mobile network operator - rain. I was responsible for the UX and UI design of both the website and Android app. I also mentored UX and UI designers within Catch & Release, as well as rain's internal UX team. ensuring that all work produced by our agency was accurately executed by rain's front-end and back-end development teams.

To support this, I created and maintained a component-based design system in Figma, standardising consistent digital output and improving efficiency.

I introduced CSS/Lottie SVG animations into the workflow incorporating lightweight, resolution independent - cross platform, interactive animations for the Android app and website.

Much of my time was spent optimising the various user journeys and new promotions and latest product offerings in conjunction with the rain team of developers and rain's CEO.

Full Stack - Dev House

Head of UX

Cape Town
March 2017 – Feb 2022

I led and mentored a young team of digital designers and front-end developers working on a wide range digital products for brands from the financial services sector, such as:

Sanlam: (Insurance & Investment Management)

Sanlam's go cover app: Full UX and UI design process for their website, android and PWA surfaces. I also set up HTML email templates, with technical testing across all email clients, and browsers and devices.

Sanlam's Concept Bluestar - Stakeholder interviews, wireframing and prototyping, front-end development and testing.

Sanlam's Glacier - Stakeholder interviews, wireframing and prototyping, front-end development and testing.

PSG: (Asset & Wealth Management)

Website and persona development, wireframing, prototyping and front-end development.

ASISA: (Investment Capital)

Website - Analysis, stakeholder interviews, wireframing, prototyping, front-end development, testing and iterating.

Publicis Machine - Agency

Head of UX

Cape Town
June 2015 – May 2016

I was responsible for all digital artefacts relating to UX and UI, persona development, stakeholder interviews, wireframes, clickable prototypes and front-end development.

I also mentored 2 front-end developers. I worked closely with Studio interpreting and adapting traditional creative executions, into useable, viable digital products. I was imbedded in a full Agile software development team and life cycle, liaising with product owners and and managers; taking responsibility for execution on the front end, and continuous iterations and user journey improvements.

Some of the brands I worked on are as follows:

- **Sanlam** (*communication campaigns*),
- **Red Bull** (*X-Fighter, communications*),
- **Appletiser** (*intranet full UX process, and front-end development*),
- **Weet-Bix** (*interactive Facebook game*),
- **SASKO** (*Responsive website - front-end development, HTML-email template creation*).

Freelance

Web Designer

Cape Town
April 2012 – June 2015

Much of my work during this time was on a consultant basis for the Protea Hotels group. I did heuristic evaluations on their existing site and brand collateral, and consumer touch points - analysed the available analytics, and assisted them to streamline the booking journey.

I also trained and assisted their designers with setting up HTML email templates that would be customised per hotel location, and work consistently across the various email clients of the time. The requirements for the templates I created had to be easy to add content without breaking the mark-up structure, while keeping brand consistency.

Global Vision

Lead Designer / Front-End Developer

Cape Town
Oct 2007 – April 2012

As lead designer and front-end developer, I managed and mentored a small team of - working on a variety of digital products from Intranets, websites, management information systems, and a variety of business applications. Notably in 2008, I created a flash based virtual exploration for Bushmills whiskey. The site featured a panoramic, interactive Irish landscape focused on the Giant's Causeway and the distillery. Users could "explore" to find hidden facts and stories about the distillers and the triple-distillation process, and stand a chance to win a 1966 MGB Roadster.

This is where I met and worked for 6 months with Phil Barret, one of the leading UX experts in SA at the time. He was contracted in for a full UX process internal CRM platform we were developing as a SaaS product in Silverlight. He was the first UX specialist I had met, and I do think this event changed my trajectory toward designing not only for aesthetic, but primarily with the users interactions, and perceptions in mind.

Laragh Courseware - E-Learning

Graphic Designer

Cape Town
Oct 2002 – Sep 2007

Laragh Courseware is an E-Learning company, that creates interactive learning materials. I created guided software simulations, in Macromedia Director and Adobe Flash.

Creating these simulations peaked my interest in UX. As I came to notice making these simulations, that software often wasn't intuitive by nature. This was when the first seed was planted around my UX thinking, and real empathy for the user.

Page Arts - Home Based Business

Graphic/Print Designer

Cape Town
Feb 2001 – Sep 2002

Page Arts (DTP) business that did print layouts for institutions like UCT's lecture materials, the Western Cape Government Statute books, as well as layouts for independent authors. I was responsible for image retouching, deep-etching and prepping files for print, and some page layouts.

Yes Xpress

Graphic & Print Designer

Cape Town, Cavendish and Blue Route Tokai, branches
Apr 1998 – Jun 2001

I worked in the document services. Specialising in high-quality signage, photocopies, and brochure print design. This was my first real job as a print designer. I was also responsible for a walk in graphic design service (being situated in malls).

McCann Erickson - Agency

Graphic Design Intern

Johannesburg
Apr 1996 – Jun 1997

After completing my Graphic Design training at Hirt & Carter, I secured an internship at McCann Erickson. In this role, I applied my newly acquired skills in Photoshop and FreeHand in a fast-paced, live production environment. I primarily worked on the Pick n Pay (PnP) account, handling deep-etching, retouching of product photography, and preparing assets for print campaigns.

Education

Transitioning from 2D to Extended Reality (XR) UX

Extra reality UX design

Cape Town
April 2025

Udemy course Exploring the transition from screen to environmental space - using different interaction use cases such as, hand gestures, spatial movements and user physical comfort.

UX South Africa

UX, UI

Cape Town
April 2016-17-18

A yearly conference that delved into the latest UX trends, how they are being adapted and what experts in the community are doing to improve on user centred design.

Flow

UX design best practices

Cape Town
February 2012

A course run by Phil Barrett from Flow, on UX design best practices covering the following topics:

- Affinity diagrams
- Point of view statements
- User scenarios
- Customer journey maps
- Storyboarding
- User personas
- Heuristic evaluations

Concept Interactive

Animation, sound integration, ActionScript 3, Lingo

Cape Town
2002

a 4 month course covering Adobe Flash, Macromedia Director.

Mac KnowHow

Advanced Photoshop course

Cape Town
2002

This covered:

- Re-touching techniques
- Colour correction
- Advanced selection techniques
- Essential principles for good design

Hirt & Carter

Comprehensive DTP, and graphic design diploma

Cape Town
1995

This covered:

- Photoshop
- Freehand
- Quark express
- Design theory, and fundamentals

Cape Town High School

High School

Cape Town
1994

- Matriculated with exception
- Prefect